

not satisfied with good things and he does not even have a proper burial, then I say, 'Better the miscarriage than he' " (Ecclesiastes 6:3).

The principle means that God expects us to be responsible. The minimum stewardship for any Christian in the area of inheritance is to have a valid will. As we just discussed, life insurance can provide the needed funds; a will determines how they are to be distributed.

What are the basic biblical guidelines for inheritance? First, God's Word teaches that you do your giving while you're still alive. The only exception is when you die prematurely. Our basic inheritance plan should be to pass along the inheritance to our children while we're alive, so we can see how they use it.

A friend, who has now gone to be with the Lord, told me, "Do your giving while you're living; then you're knowing where it's going." That's a good cliché for all of us to remember.

Too often in our generation, parents are so deeply in debt they have nothing to leave their children. I saw a bumper sticker not long ago that I thought characterized our society. It read: "I'm headed to Florida to spend my kids' inheritance."

Both husband *and* wife need wills. I have talked to people who said, "We don't need wills because we don't own anything."

In 1976, three men I knew died in accidents. Two died in a plane crash and the third in a car accident. Of the three men, only one had a will. None had any major assets. Their estates consisted primarily of life insurance that was assigned to their widows, so they felt they didn't really need wills. The settlement from the plane crash was over a million dollars, and the settlement from the automobile accident was about \$700,000. These husbands had enormous estates and didn't know it.

By the time the estates were cleared and distributed, for the two without wills, it took nearly four years and cost over \$300,000. For the husband with the will, it took 60 days and cost about \$6,000.